

THE REACTION RESET

A simple pause between feeling something and acting on it.

BEFORE YOU REACT

We all have moments when we react before we really think. A message gets sent. A conversation gets heated. You shut down. You say something you didn't mean. And later, you think:

Why did I react like that?

This isn't about never reacting.
It's about learning to notice the moment before the reaction takes over.

You don't have to use this only during a fight. Sometimes, the most useful pause happens before things get there.

PAUSE → **CHECK** → **CHOOSE**

A

PAUSE

What am I about to do?

- ☐ Send the message
- ☐ Say what I'm thinking
- ☐ Shut down
- ☐ Walk away
- ☐ Agree just to end it
- ☐ Make a quick decision
- ☐ React without thinking

Give yourself a moment before you act.

B

CHECK

What's driving my reaction right now?

- ☐ I Feel Hurt ☐ I Feel Angry ☐ I feel Misunderstood ☐ I Feel Pressured
☐ I Feel Rejected ☐ I Feel Overwhelmed ☐ I Feel Defensive

Something else: _____

C

CHOOSE

What response will actually help me here?

- ☐ Say what I mean calmly ☐ Take some time before responding
☐ Set a boundary ☐ Ask for what I need
☐ Hear the other side first ☐ Come back to this later

My next step: _____

ONE LAST PAUSE

BEFORE YOU ACT, ASK YOURSELF:

Is this how I want to handle this?

You don't have to control every feeling.

You can simply choose what you do next.

REMEMBER

A pause isn't avoidance.

Sometimes, it's the space that helps you respond with intention